PRIORITY 8 OF 33 · SCORE 3.5

Veterans Affairs

VA pairs naturally with DoD. Its service-disabled veteran-owned (SDVOSB) set-aside contracts use the same SAM.gov and FPDS pipeline, and its GI Bill school data let us screen schools. Benefit payment fraud itself (compensation, community care) is mostly hidden from public data.

INVESTIGATIONS WE PROPOSE

- **VA-1** SDVOSB fronts (the DoD screen on VA awards). **First prototype.**
- **VA-2** GI Bill school watch list: enrollment growth, caution flags, owner links to closed schools.
- **VA-3** Community care vendors on LEIE.

EXPOSURE

- VA reported $3.92B in improper and unknown payments across 7 programs in FY2025: $1.49B monetary loss and $1.74B unknown. Compensation alone was about $2.3B. (PaymentAccuracy.gov, GAO)
- SDVOSB pass-through and fake-eligibility schemes are recurring VA OIG and DOJ cases.

PUBLIC DATA WE USE

- **FPDS / USAspending** VA contracts with set-aside type.
- **SAM.gov** and **SBA VetCert** certification lists.
- **GI Bill Comparison Tool** data (school, enrollment, caution flags).
- **VA OIG reports** and DOJ releases.

HOW WE DETECT IT

1. **SDVOSB fronts:** certified firms that subcontract most work, share officers with non-veteran firms, or appear just before large awards.
2. **School risk:** GI Bill schools with fast enrollment growth, caution flags, or ownership links to schools that closed or were sanctioned.
3. **Community care providers:** cross-match VA community care vendors against HHS-OIG's exclusion list (via the HHS pipeline).

FIRST PROTOTYPE

Add VA to the DoD contractor screen (same code, VA awards) and a GI Bill school watch list.

SCORECARD

Fraud savings identified
Pending

Phase 1 window
Weeks 8–11
Jan 4, 2027 to Jan 29, 2027

Workstream
Contained pilots

FY2026 outlays
$419B · budget rank 5

Leads go to
VA OSDBU, VBA Education, VA OIG

WHY PRIORITY 8

Exposure	●●●○○
Public data	●●●●○
SBA method fit	●●●●○
Actionability	●●●○○

OUR REVIEW, DELIVERED WEEK 11

VA contractor results, school watch list, county outlier table, review memo.

Every lead goes to an Inspector General or DOJ as a referral package with sources and caveats. Nothing is published.

WHAT WE ASK OF VA

Phase 2 data: Compensation claims, community care claims, GI Bill enrollment certifications.

What it enables: Claim-level scoring; provider screens; school enrollment checks.

Access route: VA OIG.

LIMITS

Claims and community care payment details are not public.

SOURCES

- PaymentAccuracy.gov: VA
- GAO-26-108694: FY2025 improper payments

Scores and plans are our judgment from public sources. Risk indicators are leads for Inspectors General or DOJ, not accusations.

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